

D077

Concepts in Marketing, Sales, and Customer Contact

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A coffee company sells cold brew made with beans from a single farm, priced at \$4.50 a bottle. It decides to sell the drink in convenience stores and vending machines instead of only in its own cafés. Which part of the marketing mix is this decision?

- A. Place
- B. Product
- C. Promotion
- D. Price, because it sells for \$4.50

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which decision is a promotion decision?

- A. Every decision customers can see counts as promotion
- B. Running a social media campaign with influencers
- C. Adding a new flavor
- D. Setting a lower launch price

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A climbing gym with three locations in Denver, opened in 2019, targets people who value adventure, time outdoors and eco-friendly living. Which segmentation base is it using?

- A. Demographic
- B. Geographic, because the gyms are in Denver
- C. Psychographic
- D. Behavioral

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an example of behavioral segmentation?

- A. Targeting customers by how often they buy and their loyalty status
- B. Targeting customers by climate region
- C. Targeting customers by personal values
- D. Targeting customers by age and income

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Two pain relievers with identical active ingredients are made in the same factory in Ohio. Shoppers pay 40% more for the nationally advertised brand than for the store brand. What mainly explains the premium?

- A. Shoppers are always irrational
- B. Brand equity
- C. Higher product quality
- D. Higher production cost

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A company launching a patented gaming console has a \$50 million marketing budget and a large base of eager fans. It sets a high launch price and cuts the price over the next two years. Which pricing strategy is this?

- A. Penetration pricing
- B. Cost-plus pricing
- C. Psychological pricing
- D. Price skimming

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

When is penetration pricing the better choice?

- A. When buyers are price-sensitive, volume lowers unit cost, and rivals could enter easily
- B. When there are few rivals and early buyers will pay a premium
- C. When the product's costs are unknown
- D. Always, since the lowest price always wins

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A customer acquired through a referral program, who has lived in town for 10 years, spends \$200 a year at a hardware store. The store's margin is 30%, and customers like this stay about 5 years. Ignoring discounting, what is the customer's lifetime value?

- A. \$600
- B. \$60
- C. \$1,000
- D. \$300

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A customer's lifetime value is \$480, and the annual margin from that customer is \$80. Ignoring discounting, how many years is the customer expected to stay?

- A. 80 years
- B. About 0.17 years
- C. 6 years
- D. \$400

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An online ad campaign that ran on two platforms during a holiday week had 50,000 impressions, 1,000 clicks and 40 purchases. It cost \$2,000. What was the cost per acquisition?

- A. \$0.04
- B. \$0.02
- C. \$2
- D. \$50

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

During a presentation, a buyer at a 200-bed hospital that has used a competitor for three years says, “Your price is higher than what we pay now.” What should the salesperson do next?

- A.** Offer a discount and ask for the order right away.
- B.** Acknowledge the concern, ask questions to clarify it, and show the added value.
- C.** Go back to prospecting for other leads.
- D.** Promise to follow up in six months.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12.

Your current supplier, a partner for 12 years that hosts an annual golf outing, asks \$55 per unit on renewal. Another qualified supplier offers \$52 per unit, and switching would cost about \$1 per unit. What is the highest price you should accept from your current supplier?

- A.** \$52
- B.** Any price, to protect a 12-year relationship
- C.** \$53
- D.** \$55

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A coffee company sells cold brew ~~made with beans from a single farm, priced at \$4.50 a bottle~~. It decides to sell the drink in convenience stores and vending machines instead of only in its own cafés. Which part of the marketing mix is this decision?

Target word: which P **Decides:** Changing where and how buyers get the product.

A	Correct	Distribution channels are place decisions.
B	Adjacent category	The drink itself is unchanged.
C	Confusion set	Promotion is communication, not distribution.
D	Camouflage	The price is not what changed.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which decision is a promotion decision?

Target word: pick promotion **Decides:** Communicating with customers.

A	Absolute language	Each P is a distinct decision area.
B	Correct	Communicating the offer is promotion.
C	Confusion set	A product decision.
D	Adjacent category	A price decision, even when it is temporary.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A climbing gym ~~with three locations in Denver, opened in 2019~~, targets people who value adventure, time outdoors and eco-friendly living. Which segmentation base is it using?

Target word: segmentation base **Decides:** Values and lifestyle.

A	Adjacent category	Demographic is age, income, gender and similar traits.
B	Camouflage	Location is where it operates, not how it targets.
C	Correct	Lifestyle and values are psychographic.
D	Confusion set	Behavioral is about purchase and usage habits.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

Which is an example of behavioral segmentation?

Target word: pick behavioral **Decides:** Based on how customers buy or use.

A	Correct	Usage and loyalty are behavioral.
B	Inverted operation	Geographic: where they are, not what they do.
C	Confusion set	Psychographic.
D	Adjacent category	Demographic.

5. Answer B Concept 3

Two pain relievers with identical active ingredients ~~are made in the same factory in Ohio.~~ Shoppers pay 40% more for the nationally advertised brand than for the store brand. What mainly explains the premium?

Target word: source of the premium **Decides:** The products are identical; the name differs.

A	Absolute language	Buyers may value trust and familiarity.
B	Correct	The brand name itself adds perceived value.
C	Confusion set	The ingredients are identical.
D	Adjacent category	Same factory and ingredients; cost does not explain it.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A company launching a patented gaming console ~~has a \$50 million marketing budget and~~ a large base of eager fans. It sets a high launch price and cuts the price over the next two years. Which pricing strategy is this?

Target word: pricing strategy **Decides:** High at launch, lowered over time, eager early buyers.

A	Inverted operation	Penetration starts low.
B	Adjacent category	Sets price from cost, not demand over time.
C	Confusion set	Refers to prices like \$9.99, not a launch path.
D	Correct	Captures eager buyers first, then lowers price for others.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

When is penetration pricing the better choice?

Target word: conditions for penetration **Decides:** Price-sensitive mass market with scale economies.

A	Correct	Low prices build share and deter entry.
B	Inverted operation	Those are skimming conditions.
C	Confusion set	Unknown costs are not a reason to price low.
D	Absolute language	Low prices can lose money and signal low quality.

8. Answer D Concept 5

A customer ~~acquired through a referral program, who has lived in town for 10 years,~~ spends \$200 a year at a hardware store. The store's margin is 30%, and customers like this stay about 5 years. Ignoring discounting, what is the customer's lifetime value?

Target word: CLV **Decides:** $200 \times 0.30 \times 5$.

A	Camouflage	Uses the 10 years in town instead of 5 years as a customer.
B	Adjacent category	One year of margin.
C	Dropped element	Uses revenue, dropping the margin.
D	Correct	\$60 margin a year $\times$ 5 years.

9. Answer C Concept 5 · transfer

A customer's lifetime value is \$480, and the annual margin from that customer is \$80. Ignoring discounting, how many years is the customer expected to stay?

Target word: solve for retention years **Decides:** 480 / 80.

A	Wrong stem number	The annual margin figure.
B	Inverted operation	80 / 480 flips the ratio.
C	Correct	480 / 80 = 6.
D	Adjacent category	Subtracts instead of dividing, and gives dollars, not years.

10. Answer D Concept 6

An online ad campaign ~~that ran on two platforms during a holiday week~~ had 50,000 impressions, 1,000 clicks and 40 purchases. It cost \$2,000. What was the cost per acquisition?

Target word: CPA **Decides:** Spend / purchases.

A	Confusion set	Cost per impression.
B	Inverted operation	40 / 2,000 flips the ratio.
C	Adjacent category	Cost per click.
D	Correct	2,000 / 40 = 50.

11. Answer B Concept 7

During a presentation, a buyer at a ~~200-bed hospital that has used a competitor for three years~~ says, "Your price is higher than what we pay now." What should the salesperson do next?

Target word: next step in the selling process **Decides:** An objection has been raised.

A	Dropped element	Skips handling the objection and gives away margin.
B	Correct	Objections are handled before trying to close.
C	Inverted operation	Moves backward and abandons a live buyer.
D	Adjacent category	Follow-up comes after a sale, not in place of handling an objection.

12. Answer C Concept 8

Your current supplier, ~~a partner for 12 years that hosts an annual golf outing~~, asks \$55 per unit on renewal. Another qualified supplier offers \$52 per unit, and switching would cost about \$1 per unit. What is the highest price you should accept from your current supplier?

Target word: walk-away price **Decides:** BATNA = 52 + 1 switching = 53.

A	Dropped element	Drops the switching cost.
B	Camouflage	History does not set the walk-away point.
C	Correct	Paying more than your all-in alternative makes no sense.
D	Wrong stem number	The supplier's asking price.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The marketing mix (4 Ps)	Product = what is offered; price = what it costs; place = how it reaches buyers; promotion = how it is communicated.	Calling any customer-facing decision promotion, or a discount a promotion decision.	The decision's verb: design, price, distribute, advertise.
2	Segmentation bases	Demographic = who they are; geographic = where; psychographic = values and lifestyle; behavioral = how they buy and use.	Calling values demographic or loyalty psychographic.	Age and income vs. lifestyle vs. purchase habits.
3	Brand equity	Brand equity is the value a brand name adds beyond the product itself, shown by price premiums and loyalty.	Assuming a price premium must mean better quality or higher cost.	Identical products selling at different prices.
4	Skimming vs. penetration pricing	Skimming starts high for eager early buyers when competition is limited; penetration starts low to win share in price-sensitive mass markets.	Mixing up the conditions for each.	A launch price that starts high and falls, or starts low to gain share.
5	Customer lifetime value	Simple CLV = annual spend × margin × years retained.	Using revenue instead of margin, or one year instead of the relationship.	Spend, margin and retention years for a customer.
6	Digital funnel metrics	CTR = clicks / impressions; conversion rate = conversions / clicks; cost per acquisition = spend / conversions.	Reporting cost per click or per impression as cost per acquisition.	Impressions, clicks, conversions and ad spend in one stem.
7	The personal selling process	Prospect, preapproach, approach, present, handle objections, close, follow up; an objection is handled before closing.	Jumping to a discount close when an objection is raised.	A buyer raises a concern during the presentation.
8	BATNA and the walk-away point	Your walk-away point comes from your best alternative to a negotiated agreement, including the costs of switching to it.	Anchoring on the other side's offer or on the relationship.	A competing offer and a switching cost.

Course scope (public description): Concepts in Marketing, Sales, and Customer Contact introduces students to the discipline of marketing and its role within the strategic and operational environments of a business. This course covers fundamental knowledge in the area of marketing planning, including the marketing mix, while also describing basic concepts of brand management, digital marketing, customer relationship management, and personal selling and negotiating. All of this helps students identify the role of marketing within an organization. This course provides students with a business generalist overview of the field of marketing and an exploration of the marketing major.